(VHP, or World Council of Hindus)—through the Palampur Resolution on 9–11 June 1989. That resolution categorically framed the Ram Temple as an article of faith and committed the party to building it at the site of the Babri Masjid. It said:[38]

The BJP holds that the nature of this controversy is such that it just cannot be sorted out by a court of law … The BJP calls upon the Rajiv Government to adopt the same positive approach in respect of Ayodhya that the Nehru Government did with respect to Somnath. The sentiments of the people must be respected, and Ram Janmasthan [Ram's birthplace] handed over to the Hindus—if possible through a negotiated settlement or else, by legislation. Litigation certainly is no answer.

The Palampur Resolution announced the BJP's return to the politics of cultural nationalism, and was followed by the Somnath–Ayodhya Rath Yatra that catalysed its next phase of growth.

The BJP, the Sangh and Leadership

While the BJP and the RSS are separate organisations, the Sangh has played a critical role in shaping the party and its wider outlook as well as its political ground game. The BJP–RSS linkage is organic, ideological, and has political ramifications. The debate on 'dual membership' that broke the Janata Party was fundamentally about contesting ideas of nationhood (though Sangh leaders were also right to point out that the issue only surfaced as a convenient tool to fight other political battles *after* the Janata Party had acquired power with the support of RSS cadres).

The BJP has never been led by a party president who did not have an RSS history. Each of its eleven presidents between 1980 and 2020 were affiliated with the Sangh or its affiliates in the early part of their careers.[39] Prime Minister Modi began his career as an RSS pracharak, as did Prime Minister Vajpayee.

As Gujarat chief minister in 2007, Modi told an interviewer: 'I have originally been a swayamsevak of the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh. We are trained to think from a national perspective … it is my